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Interest-free financing for higher education

EARLY-STAGE CONCEPT

STUDENT SUPPORT, WITH PURPOSE

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Students focus on their education, not on how to pay for it

01

University-integrated, Sharia-guided support

Overcome education-related financial barriers through an institutional, interest-free model.

02

Proactive continuity

Aim to support students throughout their education, as funding allows, resolving balances early before registration holds become crises.

03

Protecting the student experience

Tuition pressure should never cost a student their campus standing, academic momentum, or decades of compound debt.

Early-stage thesis: institutional integration stops financial dropouts before registration holds trigger.

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Financial pressure can shape a student's whole path

Four anonymized profiles based on real experiences of New Jersey students from 2019 to 2025.

01

One Semester Away from Graduation

Final-semester tuition remained uncovered despite work and federal loans. Late fees delayed the diploma; the unpaid balance later went to collections.

02

A Dream of Medicine. A Conflict of Conviction.

Accepted to medical school without family support, this student faces high costs and interest-bearing loans that conflict with their faith.

03

A Family That Can Afford College — Just Not All at Once

Several siblings pursue college together, but upfront balances and short payment schedules make affordability and school choice difficult.

04

Working to Stay in School

Working to cover tuition and living costs leaves less time for academics; when income falls short, a student may stop out.

These stories do not establish Junnah eligibility. A future program would require students to apply for all available eligible non-interest-bearing aid first and would consider only remaining verified eligible tuition gaps, subject to funding and review.

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Interest-Free Student Financing Already Works. Access Is the Problem.

Students already seek interest-free education financing. Junnah proposes a university-integrated model to help extend access—not create demand.

01

Demand is established

Students already turn to Muslim financial institutions and charitable organizations for interest-free education financing.

02

Access is constrained

Community funding pools and charitable programs may not have the capital to serve every eligible student.

03

A new financing model

Junnah proposes partnering directly with universities to pay eligible tuition upfront, with an interest-free repayment option for students and earlier payment for institutions.

Junnah is an early-stage concept. University partnerships, funding capacity, and the scale of unmet need remain to be validated.

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Junnah is workflow infrastructure, not a chatbot or a loan marketplace

An aid-first workflow verifies the eligible tuition gap before any proposed financing.

01

Student submits a tuition-gap request

For a new term, shares school, amount, deadline, and available aid or aid-application information.

02

Verify aid and remaining gap

University confirms all available eligible aid was applied and verifies charges, balance, and deadline.

03

Review the case

A human reviewer assesses the remaining gap and circumstances.

04

Agree clear terms

Student reviews and accepts documented, principal-only terms.

05

Pay the university

Only if approved and funding is available.

06

Track and get support

Student follows principal, repayment, and hardship options.

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Same balance, very different students

Three illustrative student profiles demonstrating why human review looks at real capacity rather than automated credit scores.

01

Profile A · Employed, with family

Earns part-time wages, but income is absorbed by essential household contributions. Living at home does not mean tuition liquidity exists.

Review insight: family co-residence does not equal tuition surplus.

02

Profile B · Employed, independent

Maintains consistent employment but carries full rent, utilities, food, and transit obligations. Zero discretionary margin remains for lump-sum term fees.

Review insight: high fixed living overheads exhaust earnings.

03

Profile C · Unemployed, with family

Zero earned income. Case management reviews household capacity and employment horizon rather than dismissing the student for lacking current payroll.

Review insight: requires assessing actual household support capacity.

Fictional profiles for review design. No standard automated algorithm captures non-discretionary family support obligations.

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Fair review and principal-only repayment build student trust

01

01 · Human accountability

No standard credit-score test; human reviewers stay accountable, with documented reasons and an appeal route.

02

02 · Qard Hasan structure

Students repay principal only; $4,000 at $100 a month is 40 months, illustrative.

03

03 · Structured hardship support

Deferment, reduced payments, periodic review.

04

04 · Proposed administration fee

Illustratively $25 per new contract, charged only if approved, never at submission and never added to principal; pending legal and Sharia review, not an approved term.

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Universities pay for software; investors share eligible company profit

01

Enterprise SaaS hypotheses · University revenue models

Institutions preserve retention by clearing administrative drops. Testing software subscriptions, onboarding implementation fees, administrative servicing fees, or volume tiers.

Unvalidated hypothesis: pricing models require pilot discovery.

02

Ethical investor return · Contractual profit participation

Investors hold rights strictly to eligible operating company profits. Investor returns never touch philanthropic donations or student principal repayments.

Returns are commercial, unguaranteed, and ring-fenced from student repayments.

University willingness to pay and exact SaaS contract amounts remain unvalidated hypotheses for pilot testing.

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More university partners. More recurring revenue. Greater impact.

Junnah connects university tuition payments, student financing, and institutional revenue in one proposed platform.

01
University partnerships
Platform and service fees

→

02
Tuition paid upfront
Remaining eligible gap after aid, subject to approval and funding

→

03
Capital revolves
Principal repayments may replenish the pool

→

04
Network expands
More contracts; potential wider access

REVENUE MODEL · PROPOSED

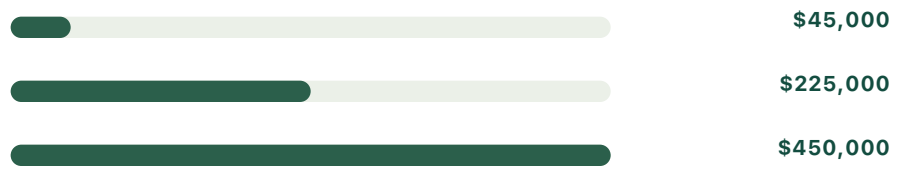
Recurring SaaS fees
University payments for ongoing platform access.

Per-student service fees
Institutional revenue that can grow with students served.

Student administration fees
Proposed one-time agreement-administration fee to cover administration, not investor returns; subject to validation and review.

ILLUSTRATIVE UNIVERSITY REVENUE · NOT A PROJECTION

Annual university revenue = (U × S) + (N × F)
Illustrative only: S = $20,000/year; F = $250/student



U = university partners · N = students served annually

FUNDING AVAILABILITY

Early on, Junnah may not be able to cover each student's full eligible balance. As revenue and financing capacity grow, our goal is to support students throughout their education, subject to available funds, approval, and university participation.

A growing university network can expand recurring institutional revenue while a revolving financing pool helps fund successive student cohorts.

Illustrative scenarios, not projections. Revenue is not profit or investor return; university revenue and pool capital are separate. Outcomes depend on adoption, repayment, available funding, costs, and final agreements. Student fees are excluded.

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Universities gain a structured path for unresolved balances

01

Retention and re-enrollment

A defined pathway for students blocked by balances. Effect on retention is to be measured with predicted higher retention and graduation rates.

02

Administrative efficiency

One place for intake, verification, review, status and reporting across departments.

03

Balance resolution

The separate pool may address a verified eligible tuition gap after available eligible non-interest-bearing aid is applied, subject to approval and funds.

04

Reporting and accountability

Applications, decisions, amounts disbursed and processing times.

05

Preventing collections at source

Upfront tuition payment can address eligible balances before they enter collections and may reduce collection risk for supported cases.

Pricing and value are unvalidated and must be tested with each institution. Junnah will not eliminate collections in every case. The university pays for software and administration only, separate from charitable funds and student repayments.

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Not Charity. Not Interest-Bearing Debt. A Different Model.

It is a proposed revolving student-financing fund: principal repayments may support future students, while university revenue is intended to fund operations. Philanthropic contributions may supplement the pool; long-term self-sustainability remains unproven.

01

Vault I · Revolving Student-Financing Pool

May include philanthropic contributions and other permitted capital. Pays approved eligible tuition balances upfront; students repay principal under agreed terms.

Repayments may be recycled for future students. Defaults, hardship relief, and fund restrictions can reduce available capital.

02

Vault II · Operating Equity / Investor Capital

Funds software engineering, compliance, operations, and team payroll. Any investment in the student-financing pool would be separately structured and governed.

Investors accept genuine business risk for a share of actual profits, not a fixed return. Student principal repayments remain separate from company revenue.

03

Vault III · Earned Revenue / University Contracts

Commercial software licenses and institutional servicing fees paid by university partners for workflow infrastructure and retention management.

Intended operating revenue for the management company; commercial viability still needs validation.

Proposed structure; legal, regulatory, accounting, and qualified Sharia review required. A revolving model does not guarantee the fund or company will become self-sustaining.

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Match each dollar to its purpose and time horizon

A proposed framework separates near-term liquidity needs from capital that may be invested over longer periods.

01

Bucket 1 · Tuition liquidity

Funds for imminent university payments, expected withdrawals, and short-term repayment gaps. Prioritize capital preservation and ready access—not investment returns.

Liquidity comes first for scheduled obligations and near-term needs.

02

Bucket 2 · Capital preservation

Funds not needed immediately could be considered for appropriately screened, relatively low-risk, liquid assets aligned with Sharia principles, subject to qualified review.

Lower risk is not no risk; asset values, access, and returns are not guaranteed.

03

Bucket 3 · Long-term growth

Only genuine surplus with a sufficiently long time horizon could be considered for diversified growth investments after near-term obligations and reserves are covered.

Greater potential upside also means potential losses and prolonged underperformance.

Concept only—not an approved investment policy or investment advice. Invest only funds whose terms permit it; student principal and restricted gifts remain separately governed. Any allocation requires cash-flow, legal/fiduciary, custody, governance, and qualified Sharia review. Values, returns, and liquidity are not guaranteed.

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Can the pool meet next semester's commitments if repayments are late?

Example model template · Opening pool + repayments received – tuition disbursed – other outflows = cash available for the next term.

01

Opening available pool

Set the initial pool size using liquid capital available for student support after restrictions and protected reserves.

02

Tuition commitments

Multiply the average eligible gap per student after aid by the number funded, and map each university payment due date.

03

Repayment schedule

Map principal due by student and date. Count repayments as cash only when received.

04

Defaults and delays

Reduce expected inflows for realistic defaults and recovery; shift receipt dates in late-payment cases.

05

Next-semester coverage test

At every due date, test whether cash on hand can meet committed eligible tuition payments if repayments arrive late.

Run base and downside cases, including late/no repayments and higher defaults. This is a model template, not a forecast; pool size, student count, funding gaps, repayment terms, and loss assumptions still need validation.

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A one-semester pilot with about 10 students tests the real workflow

01

Scope

One New Jersey university, about 10 students, one semester.

02

Long-term vision

Support from a student's first semester through graduation; the pilot starts narrow.

03

Pilot pathways

Final-semester shortfall, registration barrier, graduation-clearance barrier; rent and living costs excluded.

04

Measures

Time to decision, amounts disbursed, barrier resolved, cost per case, hardship, university willingness to renew, retention rate, graduation rate.

05

Illustrative budget

Dependent on university tuition, software/ administration costs, and number of students in pilot.

06

Aid-first requirement

Students must apply for all available eligible non-interest-bearing aid; the pilot assesses only the verified eligible tuition gap remaining afterward.

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One coordinated experience across the support model

01

Student portal

02

Case management

03

University portal

04

Investor and donor dashboards

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Where we are, and what we want from a partner

01

Where we stand

Built from lived experience. Solo software-engineer founder at pre-validation concept stage. Zero institutional partners, formal funding, or commercial revenue yet.

02

What must be validated

Legal structure, formal Sharia advisory certification, and university willingness to pay software fees.

03

What we seek from partners

Model stress-testing, introductions to New Jersey higher education leadership, pilot advisory support, and early hiring alignment.

Founder contact: madiha.abdulmaajid@gmail.com · Early-stage discussion